DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

Yesterday's daf was Bekhorot 30 — in one sentence, what was it about?

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

The Havot Yair wonders why we suspect the expert

Jev score: 0.49 — Jev-scored non-obvious illumination of the daf by a linked responsum (0.49, modest — the bar stays honest).

The source that presses back on the daf is the Havot Yair (122:15), on a modern question about a blemished firstborn shown to an expert today. He grants the baraita's rule — a single expert may not inspect his own firstborn — and then asks why Chazal suspect anyone here at all: the man could simply blemish the animal himself any day, with no legal route needed. What the daf really teaches, he suggests, is that the sages disqualify judgment only where the stakes are great, the desire fierce, and the expert's own money on the table.

That reframes the opening sugya as psychology, not procedure: inspecting another's firstborn leaves the wallet untouched, so trust is cheap; inspecting his own puts dinner on the table, so trust becomes expensive. Jev's 0.49 is honest — illumination, not revelation — but the closest any linked source came to naming what the baraita is really about.

Rejected by Jev: Introduction to Bekhorot (0.37), Tashbetz on tithe vows (0.28), Maharach Or Zarua (0.43), Havot Yair 122:2 (0.45), Jeremiah 3:14 (0.40), Jeremiah 3:22 (0.34), Rivash 406:3 (0.23), Song of Songs 7:10 (0.32).

PARSHA · LECH-LECHA

After the fall, the return to the altar

Jev score: 0.59 — Jev-scored grounding of a daf–parsha connection in the texts (0.59, the strongest of the week).

The daf's moral center is the baraita on the lapsed chaver: retraction made in public is accepted and the returnee trusted; retraction kept private is not. The prooftext is Jeremiah's 'Return, you backsliding children' (3:22), and the story is Rav Huna bar Hiyya, welcomed back by Rabba after resigning as tax collector while Rav Yosef refuses. Repentance, the daf says, is a public act before a private one.

Today's aliyah supplies the narrative: Abram descends to Egypt in the famine, deceives Pharaoh over Sarai, is expelled in disgrace — and then Genesis 13 opens with the return: he goes up from Egypt, back to the altar built 'in the beginning,' calling on God's name (13:3–4). The parsha shows repentance as geography — the same roads traveled back, the same inns, the same altar. Jev's 0.59 is the week's best: not a shared word, a shared structure.

Rejected by Jev: public-vs-private retraction in the Sarai deception (0.39), the name-greatness parallel (0.43), vested interest in Abram's refusal of Sodom's spoils (0.40), ma'aser behemah and Melchizedek's tithe (0.37), grace extended to Pharaoh (0.29).

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

NEWS CHECK

Trusting a public commitment

Jev score: 0.53 — Jev-scored meaningfulness of a daf–news link (0.53; every other story scored 0.38 or below and was rejected).

The daf asks, through Rabbi Yehuda, the uncomfortable question about trust: a chaver whose retraction was only private — public conduct continuing unchanged — cannot be re-accepted, because the public face and the private act no longer agree. This week's biggest diplomatic story is the mirror image: the US president announced an energy ceasefire between Russia and Ukraine, then suspended new Russia sanctions for a 60-day review — while Ukraine reported attacks on energy infrastructure continued, and Zelensky said the move rewarded Putin.

The link is not shared vocabulary but a shared test. A public commitment whose observance goes unobserved is precisely what Rabbi Yehuda refuses to credit. Jev scored it 0.53 — meaningful, not decisive — and rejected the other nine proposed links, from the French riots to the Peshawar collapse, as forced. One story is enough this week.

MAAGARIM · SHUV

שוב: 12,508 attestations, from return to repentance

שוב first appears where everything returns: 'until you return to the ground, for from it you were taken' (Genesis 3:19) — and then the floodwaters 'went and returned' (8:3), and the raven 'went out, going and returning' (8:7). Physical return is the word's first life; moral return is its second. By the time Jeremiah thunders 'Return, you backsliding children' (3:22) — this daf's own prooftext for accepting the lapsed chaver — שוב has grown a second soul: תשובה. The Maagarim sweep runs 575 pages and 11,493 citations from Eden to 1937, the last of them modern Hebrew fiction (Yitzhak Shami's ומעה אלאהבל'ג), still the same verb of turning. The arc: what begins as the body's movement ends as the soul's — and the daf sits exactly at the hinge.

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית *— the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language.*

929 · I KINGS 10 (CH. 297)

The summit — and the crack in the edifice

29 verses

I Kings 10 is the highest point of Solomon's reign, and it ends with the sentence that will undo him. Everything in the chapter ascends: the Queen of Sheba arrives with a great train,

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

tests the king with riddles, and finds 'there remained no more spirit in her'; gold pours in from Ophir and Tarshish; silver becomes 'as stones in Jerusalem'; and the ivory throne with its twelve lions has no equal in any kingdom. Then, almost as an afterthought, come the last four verses — horses imported from Egypt and Kue, chariots at six hundred shekels — and the reader who knows Deuteronomy 17:16 hears the violation: the king 'shall not multiply horses for himself, nor cause the people to return to Egypt.'

The commentators fasten on the chapter's opening words, לשם ה׳ — 'through the name of the Lord' — and all read them as the thesis of the whole visit. Radak hears the contrast with the sorcerers and enchanters of the ancient world, whose craft is never 'for the name of the Lord'; Solomon's wisdom is, and that is why she — herself a wise woman — comes. The Metzudat David says it plainly: she had heard that his wisdom was not of human nature but from the Lord.

The Ralbag turns her riddles into an epistemological test: a riddle admits many readings, and only a wisdom that is a divine gift could light on the reading the riddler intended. To answer her 'hard questions' is not to be clever but to be inspired. That is the standard she brought from Sheba, and the narrator's verdict is that Solomon answered all of them — 'there was nothing hidden from the king.'

The Malbim adds logistics with a flourish: Solomon's Ophir fleet sailed past Sheba's coast, and the sailors told her of his wisdom, which she understood to be divine, not natural. So she came with riddles — because, he says, riddles are precisely what mere human wisdom cannot crack, as Samson's riddle showed: no natural mind could have guessed a lion's carcass full of bees. Her test is designed to admit only one passing grade: the supernatural.

Her response is the chapter's theological pivot. After seeing the wisdom, the house, the table, and the ascent by which he went up to the house of the Lord, she blesses not Solomon but his God: 'Blessed be the LORD your God, who delighted in you.' The foreign queen becomes the chapter's theologian — the nations, as the prophets promised, acknowledging the God of Israel.

Then the catalog: six hundred sixty-six talents of gold a year, shields of beaten gold, a great throne of ivory overlaid with gold, and the fleet of Tarshish bringing gold, silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks. The numbers are almost liturgical — they accumulate the way temple inventories accumulate. But the narrator has already told us where this ends: the parallel account in Chronicles (2 Chron. 9) shares the splendor, and both tellings keep the Egypt verses last, like a crack kept for the end of the wall.

And so the summit chapter closes with the king doing business with the Egyptians and dealing in chariots — the trade that Deuteronomy forbade a king. The next chapter opens: 'But King Solomon loved many foreign women.' The arc of the book is drawn in two verses: wisdom and wealth peak in chapter 10, and the fall begins in chapter 11. The

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

commentators' consensus on v. 1 is the chapter's true epitaph — the wisdom was divine; what followed was not.

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 11:2–3

When a crack becomes a tent

2 mishnayot

Oholot 11:2

אַכְסַדְרָה שֶׁנִּסְדְּקָה, טֻמְאָה בְצַד זֶה, כֵּלִים שֶׁבַּצַּד הַשֵּׁנִי טְהוֹרִים. נָתַן אֶת רַגְלוֹ אוֹ קָנֶה מִלְמַעְלָן, עֵרֵב אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה. נָתַן אֶת הַקָּנֶה בָּאָרֶץ, אֵינוֹ מֵבִיא אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה, עַד שֶׁיִּהְיֶה גָּבֹהַּ מִן הָאָרֶץ פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח׃

A portico (aksadra) that cracked: impurity is on one side — vessels on the other side are pure. If he placed his foot or a reed on top of it, he has joined the impurity. If he placed the reed on the ground, it does not carry the impurity until it is a handbreadth above the ground.

Rambam: The crack is in the roof of the aksadra, the architrave — and its form is already known to you: it is the gate-house. When the roof split over the ground, the two halves became like right and left; and the joining of the impurity from above at the crack, or from below, applies when something bridges it a handbreadth above the ground or more, as was explained for the chimney in the middle of the house.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnat Eretz Yisrael notes that aksadra is a Greek loanword for a columned courtyard, sometimes with an upper gallery (Mishnah Middot 1:5); the phrase 'joined the impurity' (ערב את הטמאה) is unique to Oholot and here means sealing the crack — the reed on top functions as a plug, reuniting the two halves of the tent so impurity passes between them.

Oholot 11:3

סָגוֹס עָבֶה וְכֹפֶת עָבֶה אֵינָן מְבִיאִין אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה עַד שֶׁיִּהְיוּ גְבוֹהִים מִן הָאָרֶץ פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח. קְפוּלִים, זוֹ עַל גַּבֵּי זוֹ, אֵינָן מְבִיאוֹת אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה עַד שֶׁתְּהֵא הָעֶלְיוֹנָה גְבוֹהָה מִן הָאָרֶץ פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח. הָיָה אָדָם נָתוּן שָׁם, בֵּית שַׁמַּאי אוֹמְרִים, אֵינוֹ מֵבִיא אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה. וּבֵית הִלֵּל אוֹמְרִים, אָדָם חָלוּל הוּא, וְהַצַּד הָעֶלְיוֹן מֵבִיא אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה׃

A thick sagos and a thick kofet do not carry the impurity until they are a handbreadth above the ground. Folded ones, one on top of the other, do not carry the impurity until the uppermost is a handbreadth above the ground. If a person was placed there, Bet Shammai say: he does not carry the impurity; Bet Hillel say: a person is hollow, and the upper side carries the impurity.

Rambam: Sagos and kofet are vessels, as explained (Mishnah Kelim 27:2); 'thick' means a handbreadth high or more. If the impurity was on one side of the split portico and a thick garment lay under the crack, it does not count as a tent — treat it as a reed laid on the ground. But a person: Bet Shammai hold he does not join the impurity, even though his body's height exceeds a handbreadth, like sagos and kofet; Bet Hillel hold the sagos and kofet are solid while a person is hollow, and the whole upper side of him is a tent over the ground, carrying the impurity to the other side.

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnat Eretz Yisrael identifies the sagos as a thick woolen night-blanket — the Sifrei (Devarim 234) lists it as the sleeper's cover, a midrash calls it 'a vessel of the night' against the plow, 'a vessel of the day,' and the Greek translator of Judges 4:18 renders שמיכה (blanket) as sagos. Realia turns a strange rule into something tactile: Bet Hillel's human bridge is a hollow blanket of bone and breath, the upper side taut like a tent.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT SOTAH 4

The machinery of the bitter waters

19 halachot

Halachah 1

בַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בַּאֲדָר נִפְנִין בֵּית דִּין לִצָּרְכֵי הָרַבִּים. וּבוֹדְקִין עַל הָרְאוּיָה לִשְׁתּוֹת לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ. וְעַל הָרְאוּיָה לְקַנֵּא לָהּ וּלְהוֹצִיאָהּ בְּלֹא כְתֻבָּה. וּבְכָל זְמַן מַשְׁקִין אֶת הַסּוֹטוֹת:

On the fifteenth of Adar, the court attends to the needs of the community at large. [At that time,] they check which women should be compelled to drink, so that they can compel them to drink, and to which should be given a warning so that they are divorced without receiving [the money due them by virtue of] their ketubah. A sotah can, [however,] be compelled to drink at any time of the year.

Halachah 2

וְאֵין מַשְׁקִין אֶת הַסּוֹטָה אֶלָּא בַּיּוֹם. וְכָל הַיּוֹם כָּשֵׁר לְהַשְׁקוֹת סוֹטָה. וְאֵין מַשְׁקִין שְׁתֵּי סוֹטוֹת כְּאַחַת שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה טז) "וְהֶעֱמִיד אֹתָהּ הַכֹּהֵן":

A sotah is compelled to drink the bitter water only during the daytime. The entire day is fit for this purpose. Two sotot should not be compelled to drink at the same time, as implied by [the verse]: "And the priest shall have her stand."

Halachah 3

סוֹטָה שֶׁאָמְרָה אֵינִי שׁוֹתָה מֵחֲמַת יִרְאָה וָפַחַד שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהּ יְכוֹלָה לַחֲזֹר וְלוֹמַר הֲרֵינִי שׁוֹתָה. אֲבָל אָמְרָה אֵינִי שׁוֹתָה וְהִיא בְּרִיאָה וְאֵינָהּ יְרֵאָה וְלֹא פּוֹחֶדֶת אֵינָהּ יְכוֹלָה לַחֲזֹר וְלוֹמַר הִנְנִי שׁוֹתָה:

When a sotah says, "I will not drink [the bitter water]," because she is overcome by fear, she has the option of retracting and saying that she will drink the waters. If, however, she says that she will not drink when she is healthy and not affected by fear, she may not change her mind and say that she will drink [the bitter water].

Halachah 4

אָמְרָה אֵינִי שׁוֹתָה קֹדֶם שֶׁתִּמָּחֵק הַמְּגִלָּה הֲרֵי מְגִלָּתָהּ נִגְנֶזֶת וְאֵינָהּ כְּשֵׁרָה לְהַשְׁקוֹת בָּהּ סוֹטָה אַחֶרֶת. וּמְנַחָתָהּ מִתְפַּזֶּרֶת עַל הַדֶּשֶׁן. וְאִם אָמְרָה אֵינִי שׁוֹתָה אַחַר שֶׁנִּמְחֲקָה הַמְּגִלָּה מְעַרְעֲרִין אוֹתָהּ

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

וּמַשְׁקִין אוֹתָהּ בְּעַל כָּרְחָהּ׃

If she says, "I will not drink," before the scroll [with God's name] written for her is blotted out, the scroll is entombed. It is not fit to be used for another sotah. Her meal offering is scattered on the ash heap. If she says, "I will not drink [the water]," after the scroll has been blotted out, we take hold of her and force her to drink the water.

Halachah 5

וּמְאַיְמִין עָלֶיהָ שֶׁתִּשְׁתֶּה וְאוֹמְרִין לָהּ בִּתִּי אִם בָּרוּר לָךְ הַדָּבָר שֶׁטְּהוֹרָה אַתְּ עִמְּדִי עַל בֵּרְיֵךְ וּשְׁתִי וְאַל תִּפְחֲדִי לְפִי שֶׁאֵין הַמַּיִם דּוֹמִין אֶלָּא לְסַם יְבֵשׁ מֻנָּח עַל בָּשָׂר חַי. יֵשׁ שָׁם מַכָּה מְחַלְחֵל וְיוֹרֵד. אֵין שָׁם מַכָּה אֵינוֹ עוֹשֶׂה כְּלוּם׃

We intimidate her so that she will drink, and we tell her: "My daughter. If you are certain that you are innocent, stand firm. Drink [the water] without fear. For the water can be compared to the powder of a drug placed on the skin. If there is a wound, it will penetrate and descend. If there is no wound, it will have no effect."

Halachah 6

אָמְרָה טְמֵאָה אֲנִי אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁנִּמְחֲקָה הַמְּגִלָּה הַמַּיִם נִשְׁפָּכִין מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵין בָּהֶן קְדֻשָּׁה. וּמִנְחָתָהּ מִתְפַּזֶּרֶת עַל הַדֶּשֶׁן׃

If she says, "I committed adultery," although the scroll has been blotted out, the waters should be poured out, for they are not of a sacred nature, and her meal offering is scattered on the ash heap.

Halachah 7

מְגִלַּת סוֹטָה שֶׁכְּתָבָהּ בַּלַּיְלָה פְּסוּלָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְכָתַב וְגוֹ' (במדבר ה כד) "וְהִשְׁקָה" וְגוֹ' (במדבר ה כה) "וְהִקְרִיב" וְגוֹ' כְּשֵׁם שֶׁקָּרְבָּנָהּ בַּיּוֹם כָּךְ כְּתִיבַת הַמְּגִלָּה וְהַשְׁקָיָתָהּ בַּיּוֹם. כְּתָבָהּ לְמַפְרֵעַ פְּסוּלָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הָאָלָה עַל הַסֵּדֶר. כְּתָבָהּ קֹדֶם שֶׁתִּתְקַבֵּל עָלֶיהָ הַשְׁבוּעָה פְּסוּלָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה כא) "וְהִשְׁבִּיעַ" וְכָתַב׃

When the scroll for a sotah is written at night, it is unacceptable, as [implied by Numbers 5:22-25], which states: "[The priest] shall write,... he shall give to drink,... and he shall offer," [establishing an equivalence between these different activities]. Just as the sacrifice must be offered during the daytime, so too the writing of the scroll and making the woman drink must be performed during the day. If [the scroll] is written in non-sequential order, it is not acceptable, [as implied by Numbers 5:23, which] states: "[The priest shall write] these [curses]" - i.e., in sequence. If he wrote the scroll before she accepted the oath, it is unacceptable, [as implied by ibid.:21-23, which] state: "And he will administer the oath... and he will write."

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

Halachah 8

כְּתָבָהּ אִגֶּרֶת פְּסוּלָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה כג) "בַּסֵּפֶר". כְּתָבָהּ עַל שְׁנֵי דַּפִּין פְּסוּלָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּסֵּפֶר סֵפֶר אֶחָד וְלֹא שְׁנַיִם וּשְׁלֹשָׁה. וְאֵינוֹ כּוֹתֵב לֹא עַל הַנְּיָר וְלֹא עַל הַדִּפְתְּרָא אֶלָּא בִּמְגִלַּת סֵפֶר שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּסֵּפֶר. וְאִם כְּתָבָהּ עַל נְיָר אוֹ דִּפְתְּרָא פְּסוּלָה:

If he wrote it as a letter, it is unacceptable, for the verse states "on a scroll." If he writes it on two sheets [of parchment], it is unacceptable, for the verse states "on a scroll" - i.e., one and not two or three. It may not be written on paper or on untreated parchment, but rather on a parchment scroll, [as implied by] the use of the term: "on a scroll." If it is written on paper or on untreated parchment, it is unacceptable.

Halachah 9

וְאִם כְּתָבָהּ יִשְׂרְאֵל אוֹ כֹּהֵן קָטָן פְּסוּלָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה כג) "וְכָתַב הַכֹּהֵן". אֵינוֹ כּוֹתְבָהּ לֹא בְּקוֹמוֹס וְלֹא בְּקַנְקַנְתּוֹם וְלֹא בְּכָל דָּבָר שֶׁרְשׁוּמוֹ נִכָּר וְעוֹמֵד אֶלָּא בִּדְיוֹ שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ קַנְקַנְתּוֹם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְכָתַב (במדבר ה כג) "וּמָחָה" כְּתָב שֶׁהוּא יָכוֹל לְהִמָּחוֹת. וְאִם כָּתַב בְּדָבָר הַמִּתְקַיֵּם פְּסוּלָה:

If the scroll is written by an Israelite, or a priest who is a minor, it is unacceptable, for [Numbers 5:23] states: "And the priest shall write...." He should not write it with kumos, kankantum, or with any other substance that leaves a permanent mark. Instead, he should use ink without kankantum, for the verse states: "And he will write and he will blot out." [Implied is that one must] write [with a substance] that can be blotted out. If one writes with a substance that leaves a permanent impression, it is unacceptable.

Halachah 10

נִשְׁאַר בַּמְּגִלָּה רֹשֶׁם כְּתָב נִכָּר פְּסוּלָה עַד שֶׁיִּמָּחֵק יָפֶה יָפֶה. כָּתַב אוֹת אַחַת וּמְחָקָהּ וְחָזַר וְכָתַב אוֹת שְׁנִיָּה וּמְחָקָהּ עַד שֶׁהִשְׁלִים פְּסוּלָה עַד שֶׁתְּהֶיה כֻּלָּהּ כְּתוּבָה:

If [when the writing of the scroll is being blotted out] any trace of the writing remains, it is unacceptable until it is thoroughly blotted out. If [the priest] writes one letter and then blots it out, and then writes another letter and blots it out, completing [the writing of the entire scroll in this manner], it is unacceptable. It must be written out completely [at one time to be acceptable].

Halachah 11

כְּתָבָהּ שֶׁלֹּא לִשְׁמָהּ אוֹ מְחָקָהּ שֶׁלֹּא לִשְׁמָהּ פְּסוּלָה. כָּתַב שְׁתֵּי מְגִלּוֹת לִשְׁתֵּי סוֹטוֹת וּמְחָקָן לְתוֹךְ כּוֹס אֶחָד אוֹ לְתוֹךְ שְׁתֵּי כוֹסוֹת וְעֵרְבָן בְּכוֹס אֶחָד וְהִשְׁקָה לִשְׁתֵּיהֶן פְּסוּלָה. לְפִי שֶׁכָּל אַחַת מֵהֶן לֹא שָׁתְתָה מְגִלָּתָהּ. מְחָקָן בִּשְׁנֵי כוֹסוֹת וְעֵרְבָן וְחָזַר וְחִלְקָן לִשְׁנֵי הַכּוֹסוֹת לֹא יַשְׁקֶה אוֹתָן וְאִם הִשְׁקָה כָּשֵׁר. וְאִם נִשְׁפְּכוּ הַמַּיִם הֲרֵי זֶה כּוֹתֵב מְגִלָּה אַחֶרֶת וּמֵבִיא מַיִם אֲחֵרִים. נִשְׁפְּכוּ וְנִשְׁתַּיֵּר מֵהֶן לֹא יַשְׁקֶה אֶת הַשְּׁאָר. וְאִם הִשְׁקָה כָּשֵׁר:

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

If the scroll was not written for the sake of the woman, or it was not blotted out for the sake of the woman, it is unacceptable. If [a priest] wrote two scrolls, [one for each of] two sotot and blotted them out into the same cup or blotted them out into two cups, but [afterwards] mixed them together in one cup and gave the two women to drink from it, it is unacceptable. Neither of the women drank [only the water in which] her scroll [was blotted out]. If [two scrolls] were blotted out in two different cups, mixed together and then separated again into two different cups, the women should not be given the water to drink. If, however, they were forced to drink [this water], it is acceptable. If [the water prepared for a sotah] is spilled, [the priest] should write another scroll and bring other water. If [the water] spills, but some remains, the woman should not be forced to drink it. If she drinks [the remaining water], it is acceptable.

Halachah 12

מֵי סוֹטָה שֶׁלָּנוּ נִפְסָלִין בְּלִינָה. הִקְדִּים עָפָר לַמַּיִם פְּסוּלָה. לֹא הָיָה שָׁם עָפָר בַּהֵיכָל מֵבִיא עָפָר מִבַּחוּץ וּמַנִּיחוֹ בַּהֵיכָל וְלוֹקֵחַ מִמֶּנּוּ וְנוֹתֵן עַל פְּנֵי הַמַּיִם. וְאֵינוֹ מֵבִיא אֶפֶר אֲבָל מֵבִיא רַקְבּוּבִית שֶׁהִיא כְּעָפָר:

If the water for a sotah is kept overnight, it becomes unacceptable. If one placed the dust [in the cup] before the water, it is unacceptable. If there is no dust in the Sanctuary, one should bring dust from outside the Sanctuary, leave it in the Sanctuary and then take some of it and place it on the water. He should not use ash; he may, however, use rotten produce, for it is considered to be dust.

Halachah 13

וְלֹא יַחְפֹּר בְּקוֹרְדוֹם בַּהֵיכָל וְיוֹצִיא עָפָר שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה יז) "אֲשֶׁר יִהְיֶה בְּקַרְקַע הַמִּשְׁכָּן". וְאִם חָפַר וְהוֹצִיא עָפָר כָּשֵׁר:

[The priest] should not dig with a hatchet [under the floor of] the Sanctuary to remove dust, as [implied by Numbers 5:17]: "the dust that is on the earth of the Sanctuary." If one did dig and remove dust, it is acceptable.

Halachah 14

הִקְרִיב אֶת מִנְחָתָהּ וְאַחַר כָּךְ הִשְׁקָהּ כְּשֵׁרָה. נִטְמֵאת מִנְחָתָהּ קֹדֶם שֶׁנִּיחֲנָה בִּכְלִי שָׁרֵת הֲרֵי זוֹ תִּפָּדֶה כְּכָל הַמְּנָחוֹת שֶׁנִּטְמְאוּ קֹדֶם שֶׁיִּתְקַדְּשׁוּ בִּכְלִי שָׁרֵת וְיָבִיאוּ מִנְחָה אַחֶרֶת. נִטְמֵאת הַמִּנְחָה אַחַר שֶׁקִּדְּשָׁהּ בִּכְלִי שָׁרֵת הֲרֵי זוֹ תִּשָּׂרֵף. וְכֵן אִם אָמְרָה טְמֵאָה אֲנִי קֹדֶם שֶׁתִּקְמֹץ הַמִּנְחָה. אוֹ שֶׁאָמְרָה אֵינִי שׁוֹתָה. אוֹ שֶׁלֹּא רָצָה בַּעְלָהּ לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ. אוֹ שֶׁבָּאוּ עֵדֵי טֻמְאָה. אוֹ שֶׁמֵּת הוּא. אוֹ שֶׁמֵּתָה הִיא. הֲרֵי הַמִּנְחָה כֻּלָּהּ נִשְׂרֶפֶת. וְאִם אֵרַע אֶחָד מֵאֵלּוּ אַחַר שֶׁקָּרַב הַקֹּמֶץ אֵין הַשְּׁיָרִים נֶאֱכָלִין:

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

If [the priest] first brought her meal offering and then had her drink the water, it is acceptable. If her meal offering became impure before it was placed in a sacred vessel, it should be redeemed like any other meal offering that became impure before being consecrated in a sacred vessel, and she should bring another meal offering. If the meal offering became impure after being consecrated in a sacred vessel, it should be burned. Similarly, if a woman admitted to committing adultery before the fistful of meal was taken from the meal offering, she refused to drink [the water], her husband was unwilling to have her drink [the water], witnesses came [and testified that she] committed adultery, [her husband] died, or she died, the entire meal offering should be burned. If any of these things happened after the fistful of meal was offered, the remainder of the meal offering should not be eaten.

Halachah 15

הָיָה בַּעְלָהּ כֹּהֵן אֵין שְׁיָרֵי מִנְחָתָהּ נֶאֱכָלִין מִפְּנֵי שֶׁיֵּשׁ לַבַּעַל חֵלֶק בָּהֶם. וְאֵינָהּ עוֹלָה כֻּלָּהּ לְאִשִּׁים כְּמִנְחַת זְכָרֵי כְּהֵנָּה מִפְּנֵי שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהּ חֵלֶק בָּהּ. אֶלָּא הַקֹּמֶץ קָרֵב לְעַצְמוֹ וּשְׁיָרִים מִתְפַּזְּרִין עַל בֵּית הַדֶּשֶׁן. נִמְצְאוּ עֵדֶיהָ זוֹמְמִין מִנְחָתָהּ תֵּצֵא לְחֻלִּין:

If [the sotah's] husband was a priest, the remainder of her meal offering should not be eaten, because he has a portion in it. It should not, however, be burned on the altar in its entirety, as are other meal offerings brought by male priests, because the woman also has a portion in it. Therefore, the fistful [of meal] is offered as a distinct entity, and the remainder is scattered on the ash heap. If the witnesses are discovered to have lied, the meal offering is considered to be a non-sacred entity.

Halachah 16

הַמְקַנֵּא לְאִשְׁתּוֹ עַל יְדֵי אֲנָשִׁים הַרְבֵּה וְנִסְתְּרָה עִם כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד מֵהֶם הֲרֵי זֶה מֵבִיא מִנְחָה אַחַת עַל יְדֵי כֻּלָּן כְּשֶׁמַּשְׁקֶה אוֹתָהּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה טו) "מִנְחַת קְנָאֹת הִיא". מִנְחָה אַחַת לְקִנּוּיִין הַרְבֵּה:

If a man warns his wife against [entering into privacy with] several men, and she entered into privacy with each of the men in question, she is required to bring one meal offering that includes them all when her husband requires her to drink [the bitter water]. [This is implied by Numbers 5:15, which uses a plural term when referring to] "the meal offering [brought because of] the warnings" - i.e., one offering can requite several warnings.

Halachah 17

יֵשׁ לַבַּעַל לְגַלְגֵּל בִּשְׁבוּעָה עָלֶיהָ שֶׁלֹּא זִנְתָה עִם אִישׁ זֶה שֶׁקִּנֵּא לָהּ בּוֹ וְלֹא עִם אִישׁ אַחֵר. וְשֶׁלֹּא זִנְתָה תַּחְתָּיו מִשֶּׁנִּתְאָרְסָה קֹדֶם שֶׁתִּנָּשֵׂא וְלֹא אַחַר שֶׁנִּשֵּׂאת. אֲבָל אֵינוֹ מְגַלְגֵּל עָלֶיהָ שֶׁלֹּא זִנְתָה קֹדֶם הָאֵרוּסִין וְלֹא אַחַר שֶׁגֵּרְשָׁהּ אִם גֵּרְשָׁהּ וְהֶחֱזִירָהּ. שֶׁאִם זִנְתָה בְּעֵת זֶה לֹא תֵּאָסֵר עָלָיו. וְכָל שֶׁתִּבָּעֵל וְלֹא תִּהְיֶה אֲסוּרָה לוֹ אֵינוֹ מַתְנֶה עִמָּהּ. לְפִיכָךְ אִם כָּנַס יְבִמְתּוֹ אֵינוֹ מְגַלְגֵּל עָלֶיהָ שֶׁלֹּא זִנְתָה

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

כְּשֶׁהָיְתָה שׁוֹמֶרֶת יָבָם. אֲבָל מְגַלְגֵּל עָלֶיהָ שֶׁלֹּא זְנְתָה תַּחַת אָחִיו שֶׁאִם זְנְתָה תַּחַת אָחִיו הֲרֵי זוֹ אֲסוּרָה עָלָיו. וְכֵן אִם גֵּרְשָׁהּ וְהֶחֱזִירָהּ מְגַלְגֵּל עָלֶיהָ שֶׁלֹּא זְנְתָה תַּחְתָּיו בַּנִּשּׂוּאִין הָרִאשׁוֹנִים. וְיֵשׁ לוֹ לְגַלְגֵּל עָלֶיהָ בִּלְהַבָּא שֶׁלֹּא תִּזְנֶה תַּחְתָּיו וְשֶׁלֹּא תִּזְנֶה אַחַר שֶׁיַּחְזִירֶנָּה אִם יְגָרֵשׁ וְיַחֲזִיר. לְפִיכָךְ כְּשֶׁתִּזְנֶה לְהַבָּא מַיִם בּוֹדְקִין אוֹתָהּ וְיֵאָרְעוּ לָהּ אוֹתָן הַמְּאֹרָעוֹת. לְכָךְ נֶאֱמַר (במדבר ה כב) "אָמֵן אָמֵן". אָמֵן מֵאִישׁ זֶה אָמֵן מֵאִישׁ אַחֵר. אָמֵן נְשׂוּאָה אָמֵן אֲרוּסָה. אָמֵן לְשֶׁעָבַר אָמֵן לְהַבָּא:

[Based on the principle of] gilgul [sh'vuah], the husband may have the woman include in her oath that she did not commit adultery with the man concerning whom she was given a warning or with any other man, that she did not commit adultery during the time between her consecration and the consummation of the marriage, nor after the consummation. He may not, however, have her include that she did not engage in relations [with another man] before she was consecrated or between the time she was divorced [and remarried], if she was in fact divorced and remarried. The rationale is that even if she engaged in relations [with other men at that time], she would not be forbidden [to her husband]. And whenever she is not forbidden to him, he cannot make any stipulations regarding her conduct. For this reason, if a man married his yevamah, he cannot compel her to include in her oath that she did not engage in relations with others while she was waiting for him to perform yibbum. He may, however, compel her to include in her oath that she did not commit adultery when married to his brother. For if she committed adultery when married to his brother, she is forbidden to him. Similarly, if [the husband] divorced his wife and remarried her, he may compel her to include in her oath that she did not commit adultery when married to him originally. Similarly, he may have her include in her oath that she will not commit adultery in the future or that she will not commit adultery if he divorces her and remarries her. [In such an instance,] if she commits adultery in the future, the waters will check her [fidelity], and [if she is guilty,] the physical phenomena [described above] will be visited upon her. All the above is implied by [the woman's response to the oath, Numbers 5:22]: "Amen, Amen." [This can be interpreted as meaning] Amen with regard to this man; Amen with regard to others. Amen with regard to the time when I was married; Amen with regard to the time when I was consecrated. Amen with regard to the past; Amen with regard to the future.

Halachah 18

מִצְוַת חֲכָמִים עַל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְקַנְאוֹת לִנְשֵׁיהֶן שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה יד) "וְקִנֵּא אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ". וְכָל הַמְקַנֵּא אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ נִכְנָסָה בּוֹ רוּחַ טָהֳרָה. וְלֹא יְקַנֵּא לָהּ לֹא מִתּוֹךְ שְׂחוֹק וְלֹא מִתּוֹךְ שִׂיחָה וְלֹא מִתּוֹךְ קַלּוּת רֹאשׁ וְלֹא מִתּוֹךְ מְרִיבָה וְלֹא לְהַטִּיל עָלֶיהָ אֵימָה. וְאִם עָבַר וְקִנֵּא לָהּ בְּפְנֵי עֵדִים מִתּוֹךְ אֶחָד מִכָּל הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלּוּ הֲרֵי זֶה קִנּוּי:

It is a mitzvah for Israelites to issue warnings to their wives, [as implied by Numbers 5:14] "And he shall warn his wife." [Our Sages said that] whoever issues a warning to his wife has

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

become possessed by a spirit of purity. A warning should not be issued in a spirit of levity, nor in the midst of conversation, nor with frivolity, nor in the midst of an argument, nor with the purpose of instilling fear. If, however, a man transgressed and issued a warning to his wife under such circumstances, the warning is binding.

Halachah 19

אֵין רָאוּי לְקַפֵּץ וּלְקַנְאוֹת בִּפְנֵי עֵדִים תְּחִלָּה אֶלָּא בֵּינוֹ לְבֵינָהּ בְּנַחַת וּבְדֶרֶךְ טָהֳרָה וְאַזְהָרָה כְּדֵי לְהַדְרִיכָהּ בְּדֶרֶךְ יְשָׁרָה וּלְהָסִיר הַמִּכְשׁוֹל. וְכָל מִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ מַקְפִּיד עַל אִשְׁתּוֹ וְעַל בָּנָיו וּבְנֵי בֵּיתוֹ וּמַזְהִירָן וּפוֹקֵד דַּרְכֵיהֶן תָּמִיד עַד שֶׁיֵּדַע שֶׁהֵן שְׁלֵמִין מִכָּל חֵטְא וּמֵעָוֹן הֲרֵי זֶה חוֹטֵא שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (איוב ה כד) "וְיָדַעְתָּ כִּי שָׁלוֹם אָהֳלֶךָ וּפָקַדְתָּ נָוְךָ וְלֹא תֶחֱטָא":

It is not proper for a man to rush and at the outset issue a warning in the presence of witnesses. Instead, he should [first speak to his wife] privately and gently, in a spirit of purity and caution, in order to guide her to the proper path and remove obstacles. Whenever a person is not careful regarding [the conduct of] his wife, his sons and the members of his household, warning them, and scrutinizing their ways at all times so that he knows that they are perfect without sin or transgression, he is himself a sinner, as [implied by Job 5:24]: "And you shall know that your tent is at peace and scrutinize your dwelling, and you shall not sin."

Commentary

The Rambam's fourth chapter of Hilchot Sotah is the machinery room of the whole ritual: it moves from the public calendar to the intimate details of scroll, water, and dust, and ends with pastoral counsel. It opens with the court's annual review on the 15th of Adar, when the Sanhedrin decides which women to compel to drink and which to warn into divorce — the Migdal Oz, in pure source-tracer mode, anchors this in Mishnah Shekalim 1:1 and the Yerushalmi on Moed Katan. Then come the drinking logistics — by day, one woman at a time, the fearful one coaxed to retract — and a long technical sequence on the scroll: when it was written at night it is invalid, if any letter remains unblotted it is invalid, if not written for her sake it is invalid. The precision is the point: God's name is being blotted into water, and the Rambam treats every procedural flaw as fatal.

The chapter's architecture is a narrowing funnel — calendar, person, scroll, water, dust, offering — and the Tzafnat Pa'neach catches a historical aside in the first halachah: the ritual applied even in the era of Nov and Givon, when the Temple stood elsewhere, and on chol hamoed too. But the gem is halachah 14, and the Ohr Sameach's long analysis of it. If the priest brought her meal-offering first and then had her drink, it is valid — but what if the husband or wife dies, or witnesses arrive, in between? The Ohr Sameach builds a whole theory of 'sacrifices brought on a doubt': some, like the asham talui, are real offerings even

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

before the doubt resolves; others, like the sotah's offering — whose entire purpose is for the waters to test her — never become offerings at all if the test becomes impossible, following Rav Sheshet that the waters would no longer examine her. On that reading the Rambam's ruling is not a technicality but a metaphysics: an offering whose doubt can no longer be resolved was never an offering.

The chapter's final halachah is a sudden softness. After eighteen halachot of compulsion, intimidation, and invalidation, the Rambam closes: a man should not rush to warn his wife before witnesses; first he should speak to her privately and gently. The machinery of the bitter waters ends with a plea for tenderness — the ritual's severity held inside a marriage's privacy.

Commentary synthesis from Migdal Oz 4:1 (source-tracing), Ohr Sameach 4:14:1 (conceptual analysis of doubt-offerings), Tzafnat Pa'neach 4:1:1 (Nov/Givon and chol hamoed). Maggid Mishneh has no text for this chapter on Sefaria.

GOV.IL ·

The state on this week's learning

Three government publications touch the week's learning — a parsha curriculum on Lech-Lecha, the Rabbinical Courts' conference volume on the sinner who remains within Israel, and the ministry guidance for Yom HaAliyah, which falls in Lech-Lecha week.

גיליון פרשת לך לך — ביכורי גושן

gov.il פורסם באתר (המידע המשפטי/מסמכי משרד החינוך)

על אברהם שפרסם את שם ה"ומביא את דברי הרמב, גיליון לימודי לפרשת לך לך העוסק בברית אברהם ובחירתו בעולם 'ם בהלכות עבודה זרה.

https://www.gov.il/BlobFolder/legalinfo/bikureigoshen1/he/BikkureiGoshen1.pdf

התשע"ח — ספר כנס דיינים

gov.il, הנהלת בתי הדין הרבניים

דף בכורות לא — (פרשת לך לך, פרי צדיק) 'ישראל הוא — אף על פי שחטא' כרך כנס הדיינים מביא דרשה על אותו רעיון של קבלת החוזרים שבלב.

https://www.gov.il/BlobFolder/legalinfo/kenesdayanim2018/he/%D7%A1%D7%A4%D7%A8%20%D7%9B%D7%A0%D7%A1%20%D7%93%D7%99%D7%99%D7%A0%D7%99%D7%9D%20%D7%9E%D7%95%D7%A7%D7%98%D7%9F%20%D7%AA%D7%A9%D7%A2%D7%97.pdf

קליטת עלייה — מבחני תמיכה ברשויות מקומיות 2024 (פרק ו')

gov.il, משרד העלייה והקליטה

בין פרשת השבוע לחגיגת העלייה לארץ — 'לךלך' פרשת, המדריך לרשויות מציין כי יום העלייה חל בז' חשוון הקישור הרשמי.

https://www.gov.il/BlobFolder/rfp/local_authorities_aliah_procedure_2024/he/cahpter6-2024.pdf

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 2

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

Genesis 12:14–13:4

11 verses

Shnayim mikra ve'echad targum: each verse twice in Hebrew, once in Targum Onkelos. Today's aliyah is the Egypt episode and the return — Sarai taken to Pharaoh's house, the plagues, the expulsion, and the quiet journey back to the altar between Bethel and Ai.

אברם וירא

Genesis 12:14 · ×2

וַיְהִ֗י כְּבוֹא֙ אַבְרָ֔ם מִצְרַ֖יְמָה וַיִּרְא֣וּ הַמִּצְרִ֑ים אֶת־הָאִשָּׁ֖ה כִּי־יָפָ֥ה הִ֖וא מְאֹֽד׃

וַיְהִ֗י כְּבוֹא֙ אַבְרָ֔ם מִצְרַ֖יְמָה וַיִּרְא֣וּ הַמִּצְרִ֑ים אֶת־הָאִשָּׁ֖ה כִּי־יָפָ֥ה הִ֖וא מְאֹֽד׃

וַהֲוָה כַּד עַל אַבְרָם לְמִצְרָיִם וַחֲזוֹ מִצְרָאֵי יָת אִתְּתָא אֲרֵי שַׁפִּירָא הִיא לַחֲדָא׃

פרעה

Genesis 12:15 · ×2

וַיִּרְא֥וּ אֹתָ֛הּ שָׂרֵ֥י פַרְעֹ֖ה וַיְהַלְל֣וּ אֹתָ֑הּ אֶל־פַּרְעֹ֔ה וַתֻּקַּ֥ח הָאִשָּׁ֖ה בֵּ֥ית פַּרְעֹֽה׃

וַיִּרְא֥וּ אֹתָ֛הּ שָׂרֵ֥י פַרְעֹ֖ה וַיְהַלְל֣וּ אֹתָ֑הּ אֶל־פַּרְעֹ֔ה וַתֻּקַּ֥ח הָאִשָּׁ֖ה בֵּ֥ית פַּרְעֹֽה׃

וַחֲזוֹ יָתַהּ רַבְרְבֵי פַּרְעֹה וְשַׁבָּחוּ יָתַהּ לְפַרְעֹה וְאִתְּבָרַת אִתְּתָא לְבֵית פַּרְעֹה׃

Genesis 12:16 · ×2

וּלְאַבְרָ֥ם הֵיטִ֖יב בַּעֲבוּרָ֑הּ וַיְהִי־לוֹ֙ צֹ֣אן־וּבָקָ֔ר וַחֲמֹרִ֖ים וַעֲבָדִ֣ים וּשְׁפָחֹ֑ת וַאֲתֹנֹ֖ת וּגְמַלִּֽים׃

וּלְאַבְרָ֥ם הֵיטִ֖יב בַּעֲבוּרָ֑הּ וַיְהִי־לוֹ֙ צֹ֣אן־וּבָקָ֔ר וַחֲמֹרִ֖ים וַעֲבָדִ֣ים וּשְׁפָחֹ֑ת וַאֲתֹנֹ֖ת וּגְמַלִּֽים׃

וּלְאַבְרָם אוֹטִיב בְּדִילַהּ וַהֲווֹ לֵיהּ עָאן וְתוֹרִין וַחֲמָרִין וְעַבְדִין וְאַמְהָן וְאַתָנָן וְגַמְלִין׃

Genesis 12:17 · ×2

וַיְנַגַּ֤ע יְהוָה֙ | אֶת־פַּרְעֹ֔ה נְגָעִ֥ים גְּדֹלִ֖ים וְאֶת־בֵּיתֹ֑ו עַל־דְּבַ֥ר שָׂרַ֖י אֵ֥שֶׁת אַבְרָֽם׃

וַיְנַגַּ֤ע יְהוָה֙ | אֶת־פַּרְעֹ֔ה נְגָעִ֥ים גְּדֹלִ֖ים וְאֶת־בֵּיתֹ֑ו עַל־דְּבַ֥ר שָׂרַ֖י אֵ֥שֶׁת אַבְרָֽם׃

וְאַיְתִי יְיָ עַל פַּרְעֹה מַכְתָּשִׁין רַבְרְבִין וְעַל אֱנָשׁ בֵּיתֵיהּ עַל עֵיסַק שָׂרַי אִתַּת אַבְרָם׃

Genesis 12:18 · ×2

וַיִּקְרָ֣א פַרְעֹ֔ה לְאַבְרָ֖ם וַיֹּ֣אמֶר מַה־זֹּ֣את עָשִׂ֣יתָ לִּ֑י לָמָ֣ה לֹא־הִגַּ֥דְתָּ לִּ֖י כִּ֥י אִשְׁתְּךָ֖ הִֽוא׃

וַיִּקְרָ֣א פַרְעֹ֔ה לְאַבְרָ֖ם וַיֹּ֣אמֶר מַה־זֹּ֣את עָשִׂ֣יתָ לִּ֑י לָמָ֣ה לֹא־הִגַּ֥דְתָּ לִּ֖י כִּ֥י אִשְׁתְּךָ֖ הִֽוא׃

וּקְרָא פַרְעֹה לְאַבְרָם וַאֲמַר מָה דָא עֲבַדְתְּ לִי לְמָא לָא חַוִיתָא לִי אֲרֵי אִתְּתָךְ הִיא׃

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

Genesis 12:19 · ×2

לָמָּה אָמַרְתְּ֠ אֲחֹתִי הִוא וָאֶקַּח אֹתָהּ֮ לִי֒ לְאִשָּׁה֒ וְעַתָּ֗ה הִנֵּ֤ה אִשְׁתְּךָ֙ קַ֣ח וָלֵ֔ךְ׃
לָמָּה אָמַרְתְּ֠ אֲחֹתִי הִוא וָאֶקַּח אֹתָהּ֮ לִי֒ לְאִשָּׁה֒ וְעַתָּ֗ה הִנֵּ֤ה אִשְׁתְּךָ֙ קַ֣ח וָלֵ֔ךְ׃
לְמָא אֲמַרְתְּ אֲחָתִי הִיא וּדְבָרִית יָתַהּ לִי לְאִתּוּ וּכְעַן הָא אִתְּתָךְ דְּבַר וְאִיזֵיל׃

Genesis 12:20 · ×2

וַיְצַו עָלָיו פַּרְעֹה֙ אֲנָשִׁ֔ים וַיְשַׁלְּחוּ֥ אֹת֛וֹ וְאֶת־אִשְׁתּ֖וֹ וְאֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לֽוֹ׃
וַיְצַו עָלָיו פַּרְעֹה֙ אֲנָשִׁ֔ים וַיְשַׁלְּחוּ֥ אֹת֛וֹ וְאֶת־אִשְׁתּ֖וֹ וְאֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לֽוֹ׃
וּפַקֵּיד עֲלוֹהִי פַּרְעֹה גּוּבְרִין וְאַלְוִיאוּ יָתֵיהּ וְיָת אִתְּתֵיהּ וְיָת כָּל דִּילֵיהּ׃

Genesis 13:1 · ×2

וַיַּ֤עַל אַבְרָם֙ מִמִּצְרַ֣יִם ה֔וּא וְאִשְׁתּ֖וֹ וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ֙ וְלוֹט֙ עִמּ֔וֹ הַנֶּ֖גְבָּה׃
וַיַּ֤עַל אַבְרָם֙ מִמִּצְרַ֣יִם ה֔וּא וְאִשְׁתּ֖וֹ וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ֙ וְלוֹט֙ עִמּ֔וֹ הַנֶּ֖גְבָּה׃
וּסְלִיק אַבְרָם מִמִּצְרַיִם הוּא וְאִתְּתֵיהּ וְכָל דִּילֵיהּ וְלוֹט עִמֵּיהּ לְדָרוֹמָא׃

Genesis 13:2 · ×2

וְאַבְרָ֖ם כָּבֵ֣ד מְאֹ֑ד בַּמִּקְנֶ֕ה בַּכֶּ֖סֶף וּבַזָּהָֽב׃
וְאַבְרָ֖ם כָּבֵ֣ד מְאֹ֑ד בַּמִּקְנֶ֕ה בַּכֶּ֖סֶף וּבַזָּהָֽב׃
וְאַבְרָם תַּקִּיף לַחֲדָא בְּבְעִירָא בְּכַסְפָּא וּבְדַהֲבָא׃

Genesis 13:3 · ×2

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ֮ לְמַסָּעָיו֒ מִנֶּ֣גֶב וְעַד־בֵּ֣ית אֵ֔ל עַד־הַמָּקוֹם֙ אֲשֶׁר־הָיָ֣ה שָׁ֔ם אָהֳלֹ֖ה בַּתְּחִלָּ֑ה בֵּ֥ין בָּֽית־אֵ֖ל וּבֵ֥ין הָעָֽי׃
וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ֮ לְמַסָּעָיו֒ מִנֶּ֣גֶב וְעַד־בֵּ֣ית אֵ֔ל עַד־הַמָּקוֹם֙ אֲשֶׁר־הָיָ֣ה שָׁ֔ם אָהֳלֹ֖ה בַּתְּחִלָּ֑ה בֵּ֥ין בָּֽית־אֵ֖ל וּבֵ֥ין הָעָֽי׃
וַאֲזַל לְמַטְלָנוֹהִי מִדְּרוֹמָא וְעַד בֵּית אֵל עַד אַתְרָא דִּי פְרַס תַּמָּן מַשְׁכְּנֵיהּ בְּקַדְמֵיתָא בֵּין בֵּית אֵל וּבֵין עָי׃

Genesis 13:4 · ×2

אֶל־מְקוֹם֙ הַמִּזְבֵּ֔חַ אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂ֥ה שָׁ֖ם בָּרִאשֹׁנָ֑ה וַיִּקְרָ֥א שָׁ֛ם אַבְרָ֖ם בְּשֵׁ֥ם יְהוָֽה׃
אֶל־מְקוֹם֙ הַמִּזְבֵּ֔חַ אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂ֥ה שָׁ֖ם בָּרִאשֹׁנָ֑ה וַיִּקְרָ֥א שָׁ֛ם אַבְרָ֖ם בְּשֵׁ֥ם יְהוָֽה׃
לַאֲתַר מַדְבְּחָא דִּי עֲבַד תַּמָּן בְּקַדְמֵיתָא וְצַלִּי תַּמָּן אַבְרָם בִּשְׁמָא דַיְיָ׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 13:3

Shadal directly overrules Rashi's famous reading. Rashi has Abram lodging in the same inns on the way back; Shadal objects that an inn is for stopping (חנייה), not for journeying (נסיעה) — had the verse meant inns it would have said ויחן, not וילך. למסעיו means his walk was divided into many journeys with stops. A grammatical veto on an aggadic reading.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 12:19

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Ibn Ezra reads Pharaoh's confession clinically: 'I took her as my wife' means he took her to lie with her — and God's plagues were not punishment but bodyguards, 'sent to guard the wife of His friend,' so great that he could not touch her. The divine name in the verse is elohim-as-protector, not elohim-as-judge.

Onkelos: translation notes

Gen 12:17

ואיתי יי על פרעה מכתשין רברבין וינגע יהוה אתפרעה

Anti-anthropomorphism: 'the LORD struck Pharaoh' becomes 'the LORD brought great plagues upon Pharaoh.' Onkelos avoids the image of God's hand touching a man; the affliction arrives rather than being inflicted by contact.

Gen 12:20

ואלויאו יתיה וישלחו אתו

'They sent him away' becomes 'they escorted/accompanied him' — the expulsion softens into a departure with honor guard. Rashi quotes this Targum verbatim as his whole comment on the verse.

Gen 13:4

וצלי תמן אברם בשמא דיי ויקרא שם אברם בשם יהוה

Onkelos's signature move: 'he called upon the name of the LORD' — too bodily a metaphor — becomes 'he prayed in the name of the Lord.' Calling (קריאה) with the mouth becomes prayer (צלותא), the theological correction applied consistently across Genesis.

Gen 12:16

ואתנן וגמלין ואתנת

A genuine addition: the Hebrew lists sheep, cattle, donkeys, servants, maids, and she-donkeys; Onkelos appends 'and camels' (וגמלין) — no Hebrew warrant in this verse. The Targum imports the midrashic wealth-list, showing Onkelos is not always a literalist.

Gen 12:19

ודברית יתה לי לאתו ואקח אתה לי לאשה

'I took her as my wife' becomes ודברית — 'I led/carried her off.' Onkelos sharpens Pharaoh's verb: not the neutral 'take' of marriage but the carrying-off of a seizure, making Pharaoh's own mouth confess the wrong.

Gen 13:3

ואזל למטלנוהי וילך למסעיו

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

'He went by his journeys' becomes 'he went to his lodging-places' (מטלנין, from טלל, to lodge). Onkelos reads מסעים not as mere movement but as staged stopping-places — the return journey as a series of nights, anticipating Rashi's inns.

Gen 13:1

לדרומא ...וסליק אברם ממצרים הנגבה ...ויעל אברם ממצרים

Geography made explicit: ויעל ('he went up') becomes וסליק (he ascended), and the directional הנגבה ('southward') becomes the plain noun לדרומא ('to the south'). Onkelos pins the map: Egypt lies south of Canaan, and leaving it is an ascent.

Gen 12:14

ארי שפירא היא לחדא כייפה הוא מאד

'For she was very beautiful' becomes ארי שפירא היא לחדא — 'exceedingly' rendered by the Aramaic intensifier לחדא (to the extreme). The Targum's register is concrete where the Hebrew is abstract.

RASHI

Rashi on the day's aliyah

14 comments

All fourteen of Rashi's comments on Genesis 12:14–13:4, printed in full — the chest at the border, the officers' praise, the raatan plague, Pharaoh's rebuke and the escort, and the return to the inns of the way down.

ויהי כבוא אברם מצרימה.

הָיָה לוֹ לוֹמַר כְּבוֹאָם מִצְרַיְמָה? אֶלָּא לְמַד שֶׁהִטְמִין אוֹתָהּ בְּתֵבָה,

ויהי כבא אברם מצרימה *AND IT CAME TO PASS WHEN ABRAM WAS COME INTO EGYPT —It should have said, “when they were come into Egypt”;*

וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁתָּבְעוּ אֶת הַמֶּכֶס פָּתְחוּ וְרָאוּ אוֹתָהּ׃

but the use of the singular teaches us that he hid her in a chest, and when they demanded the custom dues they opened it and discovered her (Genesis Rabbah 40:5).

ויהללו אותה אל פרעה.

הִלְלוּהָ בֵּינֵיהֶם לוֹמַר הֲגוּנָה זוֹ לַמֶּלֶךְ׃

ויהללו אותה אל פרעה *AND THEY PRAISED HER TO PHARAOH — They praised her among themselves saying, “This woman is worthy of the king (i. e. they praised her as being suitable* אל פרעה *for Pharaoh).*

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

ולאברם היטיב.
פַּרְעֹה בעבורה:

ולאברם הטיב בעבורה *AND TO ABRAM HE DEALT WELL — he means Pharaoh* בעבורה *FOR HER SAKE.*

וינגע ה' וגו'.
בְּמַכַּת רָאתָן לָקָה, שֶׁהַתַּשְׁמִישׁ קָשֶׁה לוֹ (בראשית רבה):

וינגע ה' וגו *AND THE LORD PLAGUED PHARAOH etc. — He was smitten with the disease of Raathon for which marital relations are harmful.*

(ואת ביתו כְּתַרְגּוּמוֹ וְעַל אֲנַשׁ בֵּיתֵהּ
וּמִדְרָשׁוֹ לְרַבּוֹת כֹּתָלָיו וְעַמּוּדָיו וְכֵלָיו בְּרַשִׁ"י יָשָׁן):

ואת ביתו *AND HIS HOUSE — Take it as the Targum has it: "and the people of his house".*

A Midrashic explanation is:

the word את *is used here to imply that included in the curse were also its walls, pillars and its utensils (Midrash Tanchuma, Lech Lecha 5).*

The whole of this explanation of ואת ביתו *is given in an old text of Rashi.*

על דבר שרי.
עַל פִּי דִּבּוּרָהּ; אוֹמֶרֶת לַמַּלְאָךְ הַךְ, וְהוּא מַכֶּה;

על דבר שרי *BECAUSE OF SARAI (literally, by the word of Sarai) — at her orders:*

she said to the angel "Smite" and he smote (Midrash Tanchuma, Lech Lecha 5).

קח ולך.
לֹא כַּאֲבִימֶלֶךְ שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ הִנֵּה אַרְצִי לְפָנֶיךָ, אֶלָּא אָמַר לוֹ לֵךְ וְאַל תֵּעָמֵד, שֶׁהַמִּצְרִים שְׁטוּפֵי זִמָּה הֵם, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְזִרְמַת סוּסִים זִרְמָתָם: (יחזקאל כ"ג):

קח ולך *TAKE HER AND GO AWAY — Not as Abimelech who said to him (Genesis 20:15) "Behold, my land is before thee;*

dwell wherever it seemeth proper to thee":

but he (Pharaoh) said to him, "Go and do not stay here," for the Egyptians are greatly addicted to lewd-living, as it is said.

(Ezekiel 23:20). "And whose issue is like the issue of horses" (Midrash Tanchuma, Lech Lecha 5).

(The passage deals with the immoral practices of the Egyptians).

ויצו עליו.
עַל אוֹדוֹתָיו, לְשַׁלְּחוֹ וּלְשָׁמְרוֹ:

ויצו עליו *AND PHARAOH GAVE COMMAND CONCERNING HIM—* עליו *means for his sake — to escort him and to protect him.*

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

וישלחו.
כְּתַרְגּוּמוֹ וְאַלְוִיאוּ׃

וישלחו *AND THEY ACCOMPANIED HIM — as the Targum has it:*

they gave him an escort.)

ויעל אברם וגו' הנגבה.
לְבֹא לִדְרוֹמָהּ שֶׁל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר לְמַעְלָה הָלוֹךְ וְנָסוֹעַ הַנֶּגְבָּה, לְהַר הַמּוֹרִיָּה;

וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם כְּשֶׁהוּא הוֹלֵךְ מִמִּצְרַיִם לְאֶרֶץ כְּנַעַן, מִדָּרוֹם לְצָפוֹן הוּא מְהַלֵּךְ,

ויעל אברם וגו' הנגבה *AND ABRAM WENT UP [OUT OF EGYPT] ...TOWARDS THE NEGEB — He went up to proceed to the Southern part of the land of Israel — as it is said above (Genesis 12:9) "going on more and more to the Negeb" — to the Mount Moriah.*

שֶׁאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם בִּדְרוֹמָהּ שֶׁל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמוֹ שֶׁמּוֹכִיחַ בַּמַּסָּעוֹת וּבִגְבוּלֵי הָאָרֶץ׃

Still, when one goes from Egypt to the land of Canaan, one proceeds from South to North, because Egypt is to the South of the land of Israel, as may be proved from the account of the journeys that the Israelites made in the wilderness and from the description of the boundaries of the land of Israel (see Numbers 33 and Numbers 34).

כבד מאד.
טָעוּן מַשָּׂאוֹת׃

כבד מאד *VERY RICH (literally, very heavy) — heavily laden with burdens.*

וילך למסעיו.
כְּשֶׁחָזַר מִמִּצְרַיִם לְאֶרֶץ כְּנַעַן הָיָה הוֹלֵךְ וְלָן בָּאַכְסַנְיוֹת שֶׁלָּן בָּהֶם בַּהֲלִיכָתוֹ לְמִצְרַיִם, לְמֶדֶךְ דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ,

וילך למסעיו *AND HE WENT ON HIS JOURNEYS — When he returned from Egypt to the land of Canaan he went and lodged in the same inns as he had stayed when he travelled to Egypt.*

This teaches you good manners:

שֶׁלֹּא יְשַׁנֶּה אָדָם מֵאַכְסַנְיָא שֶׁלּוֹ.

that one should not change his inn (Arachin 16b);

(where the reason is given that one who does this constantly brings discredit on himself and on others).

Another interpretation:

דָּבָר אַחֵר בַּחֲזָרָתוֹ פָּרַע הַקְּפוֹתָיו (בראשית רבה):

on his return he paid the debts he had previously incurred (Genesis Rabbah 41:3).

(In both these comments emphasis is placed on "his" — he went on his journeys i.e.

the routes he had taken before.)

strow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

מנגב.

אֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם בִּדְרוֹמָהּ שֶׁל אֶרֶץ כְּנַעַן:

מנגב *FROM THE SOUTH — the land of Egypt lies to the South of the land of Canaan.*

אשר עשה שם בראשנה.

וַאֲשֶׁר קָרָא שָׁם אַבְרָם בְּשֵׁם ה' וְגַם יֵשׁ לוֹמַר וַיִּקְרָא שָׁם עַכְשָׁו בְּשֵׁם ה':

אשר עשה שם בראשונה *[UNTO THE PLACE OF THE ALTAR] WHICH HE HAD MADE THERE AT THE FIRST and WHERE ABRAM HAD CALLED [UPON THE NAME OF THE LORD] (that is, ויקרא does not introduce a further action of Abram done at that time, but refers to a former one when he had called upon the Name of the Lord);*

but it may also be explained that it means that Abram now called there upon the Name of the Lord.

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

Three comments, three relationships

On 'and it came to pass when Abram was come into Egypt' (12:14), Rashi asks why the verse says 'when he was come' in the singular, as if Abram arrived alone — and answers, almost entirely in the midrash's voice: he hid Sarai in a chest, and when the customs officers demanded the duty they opened it and discovered her (Bereshit Rabbah 40:5). This is Rashi as transmitter: the grammatical anomaly is the hook, and the aggadah is quoted in tight paraphrase, the question his own, the answer the midrash's.

On 'he went by his stages' (13:3), Rashi stages a debate with himself. First the peshat-moral: returning from Egypt, Abram lodged in the inns where he had lodged on the way down — 'this teaches you proper conduct (derekh eretz): a man should not change his inn.' Then the pivot word דבר אחר, and a second, midrashic reading: on his return he paid his debts (Bereshit Rabbah 41:3). The two readings share one verb and split the man: the moralist and the debtor. This is Rashi's signature double register — the ethical lesson and the aggadah side by side, flagged so the reader knows which is which.

On 'and they sent him away' (12:20), Rashi does something rarer: he quotes Onkelos verbatim and stops. וישלחו — 'כתרגומו ואלויהו': 'and they escorted him.' No midrash, no moral, no explanation. The Targum's softening of expulsion into escort is allowed to stand as the whole comment — Rashi judging that Onkelos has already said everything.

WORD STUDIES

Three words from the aliyah

Three words, each with a long journey through the Historical Dictionary Project — and one admission: CAL (cal.huc.edu) prohibits scraping, so Aramaic coverage here is Jastrow/BDB

astrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

via Sefaria, not the Comprehensive Aramaic Lexicon.

אַבְרָם

BDB · אברם

— n.pr.m. (id., Thes al. exalted father) Abram Gn 11:26, 27 + 57 times Gn (to 17:5) + 1 Ch 1:27 Ne 9:7; = אברהם Abraham Gn 17:5, 9, 15 + 172 times OT. (אברהם connected Gn 17:5 by word-play with הם of המון; really = אבר

BDB · אברם²

— v. אבירם, אבישי sub II. אבה.

Maagarim

אברם [שם פרטי] — 218 attestations.

אברם — 'exalted father' (BDB). The name is born in the genealogy: 'and Terah lived seventy years and begot Abram, Nahor and Haran' (Gen 11:26), the Maagarim entry's first citation. It appears 57 times in Genesis up to 17:5 — and then it dies, renamed אברהם at the covenant ('father of a multitude,' word-play on המון). After that, אברם survives almost only in retrospective lists (1 Chron 1:27, Neh 9:7). But the sweep's surprise is its second life: the 19th-century maskilim revive it — Mendel Lefin's חשבון הנפש (1844), Nahum Sokolow's 'אברם העברי' (1882) — as the emblem of the Hebrew before Israel, the solitary patriarch before the nation. The name's journey: coined in Ur, retired at the covenant, reborn in the Enlightenment.

פַּרְעֹה

Jastrow · פרעה

f.

— , pl. פרעות(b. h.;

— = preced., wild irregular growth, esp. the case of protruding boughs on one of which is an uncleanness, v. סככה. Ohol. VIII, 2 והפ׳, expl. היוצאות מן הגדר which protrude from the hedge; Tosef. ib. IX, 3 פרע היוצא מ

Jastrow · פרעה

— (b. h.) pr. n. m. Pharaoh, the Egyptian king. M. Kat. 18ª פ׳ שהיה בימי משה the Pharaoh of Moses' time. Ex. R. s. 8 מי גרם לפ׳ שילקה what was the cause of Pharaoh's being smitten?; a. v. fr.

Klein · פרעה ¹

f.n.

— disorder(?); hair(?) (in the Bible occurring only in the pl. פרעות, prob. meaning 'hair'; so that בפרע פרעות, Jud. 5:2, would mean lit. 'when the hair of the warriors grew long', i.e. 'when many vowed to go

Maagarim

פרעה [שם פרטי] — 1889 attestations.

פרעה — from Egyptian pr-ʿ3, 'great house': the palace first, then by metonymy the man who lives in it, then the title of every king of Egypt. Jastrow lists it simply as pr. n. m., Pharaoh. The Maagarim entry (1,889 occurrences) opens — fittingly — inside this very aliyah: 'and

astrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no

PARSHAT LECH-LECHA

Return, redemption, and the price of trust.

Monday, 19 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 12:14–13:4) · Daf Bekhorot 31

Pharaoh's officers saw her' (Gen 12:15), then the plagues (12:17), then the rebuke (12:18). The first Pharaoh of the Bible is Abram's Pharaoh, the one who says 'take and go.' The entry's modern tail is belletristic: Yitzhak Shami (1927) and Bialik's אגדת שלושה וארבעה (1930), where 'the queen, Bitya daughter of Pharaoh' walks through fiction. From a building to a man to a literary villain — the title never left Egypt, but it traveled everywhere.

דְּאָה

BDB · דאה

— vb. fly swiftly, dart through the air (cf. perhaps Arabic run vehemently (of camel))—

BDB · דאה²

— n.f. a bird of prey, possibly kite (Saad Bo Hieroz. ii. 191 Di Lv 11:14; Aramaic דיתא, ; NH דיה of diff. birds of prey; name prob. from flying, swooping), Lv 11:14 forbidden as food; cf. also Dt 14:13 וה

BDB · ירא

— vb. fear (NH id.; Assyrian îrû, id.; Hpt KAT2 Gloss i., COTGloss)—

Maagarim

ראי [קל] — 52251 attestations, root ראי 1 — הבטה, הסתכלות (looking, gazing).

ויראו — 'and they saw' (Gen 12:14–15), from root ר-א-ה. The Maagarim entry for ראי is the largest of the five: 52,251 occurrences, 2,255 pages, 45,081 citations — and it opens with the creation refrain, 'and God saw the light, that it was good' (Gen 1:4, 1:10, 1:12). The same verb of appraisal that God uses over creation, Pharaoh's officers use over Sarai: 'the Egyptians saw the woman, that she was very beautiful.' Jastrow's senses run from seeing to perceiving to discerning; Klein keeps the core of vision. The word's journey runs from the divine verdict (וירא אלקים כי טוב) to the human gaze — and in this aliyah, to Rashi's midrash of officers seeing her 'like a chest of treasure.' The eye travels downward; the verb does not change.

astrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Cassuto, Em LaMikra, HaKtav VeHaKabalah and Netinah LaGer have no